

Auction Checklist

Bridge Habit Map

Habits

- ☐ Check vulnerability - use to determine aggression level in competitive auction
- ☐ Always bid to show new info - stop when no new info to show
- ☐ Use every bid to get positive and negative info — partner + opps → HCP + shape
- ☐ Start from minimum length & min HCP promised — refine as bids land
- ☐ Use opps' conventional bids to show their HCP / shape
- ☐ By end of auction — summarise what you know about opps + partner - HCP and shape
- ☐ Pick a tentative opening lead during the auction

Strategy

- ☐ If it's our hand → bid our contract, or Dbl
- ☐ Watch for lead-directing double opportunities on artificial bids
- ☐ After you T/O and opps make a game try — don't push the bidding

- ☐ We have a fit AND opps have a fit + you have length or shortage in theirs → need fewer points for game (~20) in our suit

- ☐ When opps bid strangely, be careful

Bids to remember

- ☐ You can reopen with a Dbl
- ☐ Bid of a minor after 4th-hand protection shows a weak 2 in that minor
- ☐ After our T/O Dbl: NT from responder tends to show a max hand
- ☐ After our T/O Dbl: a new suit or NT is strong
- ☐ After our Neg Dbl: a new suit is a weak 6-card suit
- ☐ Opps sacrifice → partner's Dbl is for penalties
- ☐ Opps sacrifice → Pass is a forcing pass (partner must Dbl or bid the suit again)
- ☐ Opps sacrifice → bidding the suit again shows the strongest hand